

EPEAT is managed by the Green Economic Council which is a program of International Sustainability Development Foundation. To identify products as EPEAT bronze, silver or gold the organization has signed an MOU with a group of technical and environmental assessment organizations. Computing equipments are evaluated on 53 criteria, some mandatory and some optional, that measure the efficiency and sustainability of products. Products are rated bronze, silver and gold on the basis of how many optional criteria they meet. Since 2010, Amazon began using EPEAT criteria on its website to identify greener electronic products.

Eco- Buying Guide

There are several guides available online which list out criterion to be considered for buying various environmental friendly products. Here we provide some criterion for buying laptops the green way.



- ▶ Evaluate your needs- First of all, do you really need that new laptop? If not, then don't buy it. Not even if it is the latest sleek model with that uber-cool interface.
- ▶ If yes, then try and figure out what you need it for. This will help you purchase the most efficient laptop for your use. If you are a casual user and need to use it for simple tasks like checking mail, surfing the web then look at notebooks or tablet computers which are not only cheaper but also use lesser energy. A tablet could further eliminate the need of an e- reader.
- ▶ If you plan to use the laptop in extreme conditions, damp climate, high temperature, or more or less any part of India, then go for a sturdy laptop as that will last longer.
- ▶ Add-ons like extra memory, blu-ray drive, extra RAM, etc. should be ordered with the laptop itself, rather than ordering it separately. This will reduce the carbon footprint by removing the material and energy costs associated with ordering, shipping and installing.
- ▶ Try to look for low power components. With the trend of making more power efficient computers taking hold of the computer industry, low power components are increasingly becoming more available. Solid state drives are one example. While costlier than your run of the mill